

Furman Pauper Players Constitution

Updated Spring 2015

Introduction: Founding

In 1992, an ambitious and talented sophomore named Mary Mitchell Campbell noticed that one form of the arts was glaringly absent from Furman's campus—musical theatre. At the time, a musical had not been staged at Furman since a production of "South Pacific" twenty-seven years prior. Campbell had found her mission; she gathered a group of interested friends and vowed to end musical theatre's invisibility. The Furman Pauper Players, named so on account of the group's meager, personally supplied budget, marked the beginning of a new era with their first entirely student-run production of "Nunsense." In the subsequent year, Campbell continued to astound audiences, often parents at Parents' Weekend, with her delightful interpretations of musicals like "Godspell" and "Joseph and the Amazing Technicolor Dreamcoat." Campbell's legacy will continue through primarily student-run musical theatre productions. She began what would undoubtedly become a beloved Furman tradition.

Article I: Name

The name of this organization is the Furman Pauper Players (FPP).

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of FPP is twofold:

1. To perform quality musical theatre productions at Furman University.
2. To provide motivated students of any major or background with the opportunity to sharpen their skills in leadership, communication, performance, cooperation, and responsibility.

Article III: Membership

Section I.

Any interested Furman students are welcome to become members of FPP. After involvement in just one show, a student is considered to be a member of FPP. While auditions are necessary for any stage production, interested students and FPP members who are not cast in any given show will be invited to help with offstage facets of the production—lighting, sound, costumes, props, publicity etc. All members are subject to the terms of this constitution.

Section II.

Any interested member of FPP is eligible to become a member of the FPP Council by going through the application process released by the current council during the Spring semester.

Article IV: Council

Section I: Members of Council

The Council will comprise experienced Pauper Players selected through an application process explained in Section V. By a majority vote, the size of Council can increase or decrease as deemed necessary by the current Council. Members of Council are responsible for making executive decisions regarding the performance calendar, show selection, director selection, and any other administrative aspect of the organization.

Members of Council who do not hold executive officer positions can perform executive duties in the absence of the elected officers as decided upon by the president. These members will also serve on ad hoc committees formed throughout the year.

Section II: Executive Officers and Responsibilities

The President shall be responsible for:

- A. Presiding over Council meetings.
- B. Acting as the primary ambassador of FPP to the university.
- C. Delegating responsibilities to members of the Council and forming ad hoc committees.
- D. Counting votes during Council meetings.

The Treasurer shall be responsible for:

- A. All fiscal business of FPP, which includes writing checks, withdrawing and depositing money. The use of a debit card is advised against.
- B. Creating a budget to submit to the Student Government Association.
- C. Working together with SGA to alter the budget should any changes be necessary.
- D. Deciding upon allocations of the budget in coordination with the directors of each show. Allocations are to be presented to the Council and voted on by a majority vote.
- E. Working with the director(s) of each show to keep them aware of their budget allowances and limitations.
- F. Refunding those who spent money for FPP from the FPP bank account with the Bank of Traveler's Rest.
- G. Acquiring reimbursement from SGA.
- H. Making weekly financial reports at Council meetings.

The Secretary shall be responsible for:

- A. Taking roll at the start of each Council meeting.
- B. Taking minutes at each Council meeting.
- C. Sending the minutes to all members of the Council and its advisors.
- D. Promoting communication within the Council itself.
- E. Keeping a list of the active members of FPP.
- F. Collecting votes during Council meetings and recounting the votes after the President.
- G. maintaining and updating the Constitution and Bylaws.

The Publicity Committee shall comprise the Public Relations Chair and Social Media Chair.

The Public Relations Chair shall be responsible for:

- A. Publicizing FPP auditions, performances, and other events around the university and in the community.
- B. Publicizing FPP itself.
- C. Obtaining assistance from any members of FPP for publicity purposes whenever necessary.
- D. Making weekly publicity reports at Council meetings.

The Social Media Chair shall be responsible for:

- A. Publicizing all the above mentioned FPP events through social media accounts including but not limited to Facebook, Twitter and Instagram.
- B. Updating FPP website.

The Events Coordinator shall be responsible for:

- A. Serving as Front of House during the two major musicals.
- B. Coordinating all Pauper Players events aside from the two major musical productions.
- C. Reserving the space for such events.
- D. Serving as the liaison between Council and the Director of the Cabaret.

A Delegate to the Production Team will be elected before each musical by a majority vote. That person shall be responsible for:

- A. Attending all production team meetings.
- B. Serving as an extra liaison between Council and the production team.
- C. Voicing concerns of the Council to the production team.
- D. The delegate is permitted to hold another executive position.

Section III: Meetings

The FPP Council will meet once a week at a regular time decided upon by the Council members. At each meeting, officers will make their weekly reports and any other necessary business will be made known. FPP business should be kept private and should not be discussed outside of meetings. Each member of Council will be allowed two unexcused absences and two excused absences each semester. For an absence to be excused, you must give the secretary 24 hours of notice.

Section IV: Council Presence

The FPP Council is to serve the role of producers for each of its productions and its presence needs to be felt by the members of FPP. All members of Council, if they are not already involved in the production, are required to attend at least one rehearsal to check up on progress and see if anything needs to be

done by the Council to aid the director or the progress of the show. Each member will report their rehearsal attendance and observations at the following Council meeting.

Section V: Council Applications

Any interested member of FPP is eligible to apply for FPP Council by going through the application process announced by the current Council in the Spring semester. After reviewing all applicants, new Council members will be chosen by a majority vote of the current Council. The appropriate size of the Council will be determined by the current Council with a minimum of six members and maximum of ten. This number does not include all members of the Joint Council.

Section VI: Officer Selection

After the new Council members have been selected, the officers for the upcoming year will be selected from the current Council. The graduating seniors will preside over the elections and officers will be chosen by a discussion and a majority vote. Former officers will teach the newly elected officers about their duties. Graduating seniors have a vote in officer elections.

Section VII: Provisions for Recall

Members of FPP Council may be removed from the Council for malfeasance in the office. The issue must be brought up by one third of the Council members, and the offending member may be removed if five of the seven Council members agree.

Article V: Shows

Section I: Director and Show Selection

Any member of FPP, regardless of their position in the organization, is eligible to direct a FPP show. A student interested in directing must choose the show that he/she would like to direct and form a proposal to be presented at a Council meeting. The proposal should include creative concepts for the music and set design, where the show will be performed, potential crew members, and a tentative timeline for rehearsals and tech week. After all interested parties have made their proposals, the FPP Council will discuss and choose by a two-thirds majority vote the directors and shows for the upcoming season. Shows and directors for the next season will be decided upon by the end of the Spring semester the school year before the upcoming season. Following the Director Selection Process, the Council will release an additional application for Cabaret Directors.

Section II: Responsibilities of the Director

The responsibilities of the directors are as follows:

- A. Complete responsibility for the show and has at his/her disposal the allocated resources of FPP Council.
- B. During the preparations for the show, the FPP Council can request to meet with the director at any time to give feedback and suggestions.
- C. Communicate regularly with the cast, crew, and Council members to make sure that preparations are going smoothly and are within the show's budget.
- D. Regularly attend Council meetings during the production of his/her show.
- E. Selecting crew members with the assistance of the Council, including but not limited to: Assistant Director, Music Director, Stage Manager, Technical Director, Lighting Designer, Set Designer, Costume Manager, Props Manager, Publicity Manager, and Choreographer.
- F. Larger scale shows must have at least two people in charge; the director and his/her assistant (who may be, for example, the Music Director or Technical Director).
- G. Deciding upon the attendance policy for rehearsals and making it known to cast and crew at the very beginning of production.
- H. Act in a professional manner at all times, since he/she is representing the entire organization.
- I. If a cast or crew member is not fulfilling his/her responsibilities by coming to rehearsal and learning music and lines, the director has the authority to remove him/her from the show and find a replacement if necessary.
- J. If FPP Council feels that a director is not fulfilling the aforementioned requirements, the Council may replace the director with a majority vote.

Sections III: Rehearsals

Rehearsals will occur several times a week over a period of four to six weeks for any given show. Attendance is mandatory at all rehearsals for called cast and crew members. Individual cast members should practice at home in order to increase the efficiency and productivity of group rehearsals. If a rehearsal is missed, it is the individual's responsibility to learn and practice the missed material. The director must decide at the onset of a production what the attendance policy for rehearsals will be; the cast and crew must be notified of the policy at the very beginning of production.

Section IV: Performances

The number of performances for any given FPP show will vary, though it should not be excessive and, thus, grueling. The times and places of performances will be known at the time of director and show selection the Spring semester prior to the season.

Article VI: Faculty Involvement

Section I: Advisor

The advisor of FPP is any supportive and willing Furman faculty or staff member who will serve as a non-voting member of the organization. The advisor shall assist the group in the execution of roles and responsibilities, provide feedback to the organization regarding its operation and function, and serve as a resource to FPP, sharing knowledge, expertise, and experience with the group.

Section II: Liaison from the Music Department

The liaison from the music department is any Furman music faculty member willing to give his/her support to FPP. The liaison from the music department will assist FPP with synchronizing the music department's and FPP's calendars and encouraging support for the organization from the other members of the music faculty.

Section III: Liaison from the Theatre Department

The liaison from the theatre department is any theatre faculty member willing to give his/her support to FPP. The liaison from the theatre department will assist FPP with synchronizing the theatre department's and FPP's calendars and encouraging support for the organization from the other members of the theatre faculty.

Section IV: Restrictions

FPP is a completely student-run organization, and faculty advisors and/or liaisons will not be allowed to choose Council members, serve on the Council, and choose directors or shows. Council will inform advisors of any pertinent information.

Article VII: Provisions for Amending the Constitution

Amendments may be made to the FPP Constitution by a majority vote of the members of FPP Council.